

CAREER PATHS

Graduates with a degree in a numerate subject can apply to train as an actuary. Training involves several years of on-the-job study, during which time trainees need to take a series of exams to gain professional accreditation.

GRADUATE To be taken on as a trainee, you will need a degree in mathematics, statistics, or a similar subject, and will then have to pass a series of selection tests.

POSTGRADUATE You can increase your chances of being taken on by studying actuarial science at the graduate level, which may also count toward your future accreditation.



ACTUARY Traditionally employed by insurance firms, actuaries now work for a range of organizations, from consulting firms and health authorities to government departments. After qualifying, you can specialize in a particular sector or work toward senior roles.



INVESTMENT BANK ACTUARY Conducts research to identify the financial costs and potential risks of investment decisions, such as investing in a new business.



CONSULTANT ACTUARY Advises on business activities, such as large companies' pension or health plans, complying with legal requirements.



LIFE INSURANCE ACTUARY Analyzes statistical information on risk factors—such as existing health conditions—to set the prices that customers pay for their life insurance policies.



CHIEF RISK OFFICER Coordinates a team of actuaries and other professionals who assess and take action to avoid potential risks. This is a senior position in a large company.



ENTERPRISE RISK MANAGER Identifies risks that may affect the operation of a business, and then assesses the impact these risks might have. Also devises strategies to avoid these risks or to minimize their effects on the business.

SKILLS GUIDE



Strong communication and presentation skills for explaining complex findings.



A logical and analytical approach to make sense of complex information.



Advanced numerical skills to analyze and interpret large amounts of data.



A thorough knowledge of issues affecting financial markets when pricing products and services.



Precision and attention to detail to ensure mathematical calculations are correct.